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EUROPEAN DISHES

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**LATER IS TOO LATE:
SAY NO TO OBESITY NOW**



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ABOUT THIS PUBLICATION

European Dishes is an educational output of the Erasmus+ small-scale partnership Later Is Too Late: Say No to Obesity Now. Students and teachers from four partner schools shared traditional recipes to support intercultural learning and conversations about food, wellbeing and healthier choices.

PROJECT DETAILS

Project

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PARTNER SCHOOLS



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CIORBĂ DE PERIȘOARE

ROMANIA

Meatball soup

Cooking steps

1. Cut 2 carrots, 1 onion, 2 peppers, and 1 celery stalk into small cubes. Fry them in oil in a large pot.
2. Mix 600 g of minced meat with 1 onion, 70 g of rice, 1 egg, 1 teaspoon of salt, and a pinch of pepper. Form the meatballs with wet hands.
3. When the vegetables are tender, add boiling water and 2 teaspoons of Delikat. Let it simmer for about 2 minutes.
4. Add the meatballs one by one to the surface of the pot without crowding them. Cook for 15 minutes, or until cooked through.
5. Add 300 ml of tomato juice and borș (sour fermented liquid). Let it simmer for a few more minutes.
6. Add chopped parsley leaves and serve.

Prepared by Nela Dumea's Team





PAPANASI

ROMANIA

Romanian doughnuts

Cooking steps

1. Mix 250 g of cottage cheese, 1 egg, 3 - 4 tablespoons of sugar, 1 teaspoon of vanilla, the zest of 1 lemon, 1 teaspoon of baking powder, and about 150 g of flour until a soft dough forms.
2. Shape the dough into 6 - 8 discs and 6 - 8 small balls.
3. Heat about 500 ml of oil in a pan over medium heat.
4. Fry the discs and balls until golden, then drain them on paper towels.
5. Serve each portion with 2 - 3 tablespoons of sour cream and 2 - 3 tablespoons of jam.

Prepared by Nela Dumea's Team





Cornmeal cake

Cooking steps

1. Combine cornmeal with wheat flour, a pinch of salt, and a generous amount of fresh cottage cheese or curd.
2. Stir in thick sour cream, melted butter, and 3 - 4 eggs until you obtain a thick, pourable batter.
3. Fold in some chopped fresh dill, or add vanilla if you prefer a sweet version.
4. Pour the mixture into a greased tray and bake at 180°C until the top is golden brown and firm.
5. Cut into squares and serve warm with an extra dollop of cold sour cream on top.

Prepared by Nela Dumea's Team





OSTROPEL DE PUI

ROMANIA

Chicken stew

Cooking steps

1. Fry chicken thighs or drumsticks in a pan with a little oil until they develop a golden crust.
2. Remove the chicken. In the same oil, sauté a little tomato paste and 1 tablespoon of flour for 1 minute.
3. Add water or chicken stock and return the meat to the pan. Simmer until the chicken is tender and the sauce thickens.
4. Season with salt and pepper. Add a handful of fresh parsley and serve with polenta.

Prepared by Nela Dumea's Team





Vegetable spread

Cooking steps

1. Grill eggplants and red peppers over an open flame until their skins are charred. Peel them and allow them to drain.
2. Finely chop the roasted vegetables. Sauté finely diced onions in a generous amount of sunflower oil until translucent.
3. Add the chopped vegetables and tomato juice to the onions. Mix everything in a large pot.
4. Simmer over very low heat for several hours, stirring regularly, until the oil begins to rise to the surface.
5. Season with salt, peppercorns, and bay leaves. Pour into sterilised jars for storage.

Prepared by Nela Dumea's Team





VARZĂ À LA CLUJ

ROMANIA

Cluj-style cabbage casserole

Cooking steps

1. Finely shred the cabbage and sauté it lightly with oil and a little salt until softened. If using fresh cabbage, this helps remove bitterness and excess moisture.
2. Sauté chopped onions until translucent. Add the minced meat, season with salt, pepper, and paprika, and cook until lightly browned.
3. Stir washed rice into the meat mixture. Add tomato paste or tomato juice and cook briefly so the flavours combine without fully cooking the rice.
4. In a baking dish, alternate layers of cabbage and meat mixture, beginning and ending with cabbage. Press gently to compact the layers.
5. Cover and bake at a moderate temperature until the rice is fully cooked and the flavours have blended. Serve hot with sour cream.

Prepared by Nela Dumea's Team





POALE-N BRÂU

ROMANIA

Cheese-filled pastries

Cooking steps

1. Prepare the yeast dough by mixing warm milk, yeast, sugar, eggs, oil or butter, and flour. Knead until soft and elastic, then cover and leave to rise until doubled in size.
2. Combine cheese with eggs, sugar, lemon zest or vanilla, and raisins if desired. Mix until creamy but not runny.
3. Divide the dough into small balls and roll each one into a circle. Place filling in the centre, then fold the edges towards the middle, slightly overlapping them while leaving the centre visible.
4. Place the pastries on a baking tray and leave them to rise again briefly. Brush with beaten egg for a golden crust.
5. Bake at a moderate temperature until puffed and lightly browned. Allow to cool slightly before serving.

Prepared by Nela Dumea's Team





BORȘ DE SFECLĂ

ROMANIA

Beet borscht

Cooking steps

1. Peel and grate or julienne the beetroot. Finely chop the onion, carrot, and celery. Dice the potatoes if using.
2. Heat oil in a pot and sauté the onion until translucent. Add the carrot, celery, and beetroot, and cook gently for 2 - 3 minutes to release their flavour and colour.
3. Add hot water or vegetable stock and the potatoes, if included. Simmer until all the vegetables are tender.
4. Boil the borș separately, then add it to the pot. Simmer for another 5 - 10 minutes and adjust the salt to taste.
5. Remove from the heat and add chopped lovage or celery leaves. Cover and leave to rest for a few minutes before serving.

Prepared by Nela Dumea's Team





SARMA

TÜRKİYE

Stuffed grape leaves

Cooking steps

1. Wash the grape leaves and soak them in warm water.
2. Mix rice, chopped onion, tomato paste, olive oil, salt, pepper, and herbs in a bowl.
3. Place a small amount of filling on each grape leaf.
4. Roll the leaves tightly into small cylinders.
5. Arrange the rolls in a pot.
6. Add water and a little olive oil.
7. Cook over low heat for about 40 - 50 minutes, until the rice is tender.
8. Allow them to cool slightly before serving.

Prepared by Desen Sultan Ürün's Team





DÖNER

TÜRKİYE

Rotisserie-style meat

Cooking steps

1. Slice the meat - beef, lamb, or chicken - thinly.
2. Marinate it with yoghurt, oil, onion, garlic, and spices.
3. Leave it in the refrigerator for several hours.
4. Stack the meat on a vertical spit.
5. Cook it slowly while rotating it in front of the heat.
6. Slice off thin cooked layers as the outside browns.
7. Serve in bread or a wrap with vegetables and sauce.

Prepared by Desen Sultan Ürün's Team





ADANA KEBAP

TÜRKİYE

Spiced lamb kebab

Cooking steps

1. Finely chop the lamb and mix it with tail fat, which is important for flavour and texture.
2. Add salt, red pepper flakes (isot), and paprika. Mix thoroughly until it forms a sticky mince.
3. Leave the mixture to rest in the refrigerator so the flavours combine.
4. Take portions of the meat and press them firmly onto wide metal skewers.
5. Shape the mixture evenly along each skewer so that it does not fall apart while cooking.
6. Cook over a charcoal grill, turning the skewers so that they cook evenly.
7. Allow the outside to become slightly crisp while the inside remains juicy.
8. Serve with flatbread, grilled vegetables, onions, and parsley.

Prepared by Rabia Müjde Dinçer's Team





Yoghurt and cucumber soup

Cooking steps

1. Peel and grate or finely chop the cucumber.
2. Mix the yoghurt with a little water until it reaches a smooth, liquid consistency.
3. Add the cucumber to the yoghurt mixture.
4. Add salt, minced garlic, and dried mint or fresh dill.
5. Stir until evenly combined.
6. Chill briefly before serving.
7. Serve cold, optionally topped with olive oil.

Prepared by Rabia Müjde Dinçer's Team





LAHMACUN

TÜRKİYE

Thin flatbread with seasoned meat

Cooking steps

1. Prepare a soft dough using flour, water, yeast, and salt. Knead well and leave it to rise.
2. Prepare the topping by mixing minced meat with finely chopped onion, tomato, green pepper, garlic, parsley, tomato paste, and spices.
3. Roll the dough into thin, round discs.
4. Spread a thin layer of the meat mixture evenly over each piece of dough.
5. Bake in a very hot oven or stone oven until the edges are crisp and the topping is cooked.
6. Remove from the oven and optionally add lemon juice, parsley, or vegetables before serving.

Prepared by Tolga Ürün's Team





MANTI

TÜRKİYE

Turkish dumplings

Cooking steps

1. Prepare a dough using flour, water, salt, and eggs. Knead until smooth and leave it to rest.
2. Mix minced meat with finely chopped onion, salt, and pepper for the filling.
3. Roll the dough into a thin sheet and cut it into small squares.
4. Place a small amount of filling in the centre of each square.
5. Fold and pinch the edges to form small dumplings.
6. Boil the dumplings in salted water until they float and are cooked through.
7. Serve with garlic yoghurt and melted butter mixed with paprika or chilli flakes.

Prepared by Tolga Ürün's Team





BAKLAVA

TÜRKİYE

Layered nut pastry

Cooking steps

1. Prepare a simple syrup with sugar and water, then allow it to cool completely.
2. Mix chopped nuts, usually pistachios or walnuts.
3. Brush a baking tray with butter and layer thin sheets of phyllo dough, brushing each layer with melted butter.
4. Add a layer of nuts in the middle, then continue layering phyllo sheets on top.
5. Cut the baklava into diamond or square shapes before baking.
6. Bake in a preheated oven until golden and crisp.
7. Pour the cooled syrup over the hot baklava immediately after baking.
8. Leave it to rest so that it fully absorbs the syrup before serving.

Prepared by Yusuf Ekmen's Team





MENEMEN

TÜRKİYE

Tomato and egg skillet

Cooking steps

1. Heat olive oil or butter in a pan.
2. Add chopped onion, if using, and sauté until soft.
3. Add chopped green peppers and cook until softened.
4. Add diced or grated tomatoes and cook until they break down into a sauce.
5. Season with salt and, optionally, black pepper or red pepper flakes.
6. Crack the eggs directly into the mixture, or whisk them separately before adding.
7. Stir gently, or leave the mixture slightly runny, according to preference.
8. Cook until the eggs are set but still soft.
9. Serve hot, usually with bread.

Prepared by Yusuf Ekmen's Team





Maltese tuna and tomato sandwich

Cooking steps

1. Cut the ftira bread in half.
2. Wash and slice the tomatoes.
3. Add lettuce, tomatoes, olives, and capers to the bread.
4. Place the tuna on top of the vegetables.
5. Drizzle with olive oil.
6. Close the sandwich and serve.

Prepared by Emanuel John Falzon's Team





PASTIZZI

MALTA

Maltese savoury pastries

Cooking steps

1. Choose a filling: seasoned ricotta, or soft mashed peas cooked with onion and mild spices.
2. Roll chilled flaky pastry into a thin sheet and cut it into even pieces.
3. Place a small spoonful of filling in the centre of each piece.
4. Fold and pinch the pastry into the traditional pointed or oval shape, keeping the filling enclosed.
5. Arrange the pastries on a lined baking tray and chill briefly so that they hold their shape.
6. Bake in a hot oven until the pastry is puffed, deeply golden, and crisp.
7. Allow to cool for a few minutes and serve warm.

Prepared by Emanuel John Falzon's Team





STUFFAT TAL-FENEK

MALTA

Maltese rabbit stew

Cooking steps

1. Marinate the rabbit pieces with red wine, garlic, bay leaves, salt, and pepper.
2. Drain the rabbit, reserving the marinade, and brown the pieces in olive oil.
3. Remove the rabbit and gently cook chopped onion, carrot, and garlic in the same pot.
4. Stir in tomato paste and chopped tomatoes, then add the reserved wine marinade and a little stock.
5. Return the rabbit to the pot, cover, and simmer slowly until tender.
6. Add potatoes or peas near the end of cooking, if desired, and cook until soft.
7. Adjust the seasoning and serve with crusty bread or pasta.

Prepared by Emanuel John Falzon's Team





Maltese fish soup

Cooking steps

1. Sauté chopped onion and garlic in olive oil until soft.
2. Add chopped tomatoes, tomato paste, parsley, mint, and a bay leaf.
3. Pour in fish stock or water and simmer gently so the flavours combine.
4. Add pieces of firm white fish and cook until just tender.
5. Stir in a small amount of rice and simmer until the grains are cooked.
6. Season with salt and pepper, then finish with lemon juice and chopped parsley.
7. Serve hot with toasted bread.

Prepared by Emanuel John Falzon's Team





Maltese broad-bean dip

Cooking steps

1. Soak dried broad beans overnight, then drain and rinse them.
2. Cover the beans with fresh water and simmer until very soft.
3. Drain well, reserving a little cooking liquid.
4. Mash or blend the beans with garlic, parsley, chilli, lemon juice, and olive oil.
5. Add a little reserved liquid if needed to obtain a thick, spreadable texture.
6. Season with salt and pepper and drizzle with extra olive oil.
7. Serve at room temperature with Maltese bread or crackers.

Prepared by Emanuel John Falzon's Team





TIMPANA

MALTA

Maltese baked pasta pie

Cooking steps

1. Cook short pasta until just underdone, then drain it well.
2. Prepare a rich tomato and minced-meat sauce with onion, garlic, and herbs.
3. Mix the pasta with the sauce, beaten egg, and grated cheese.
4. Line a deep baking dish with pastry, leaving enough pastry to cover the top.
5. Spoon in the pasta mixture and press it down gently.
6. Cover with pastry, seal the edges, and cut a small steam vent.
7. Brush with beaten egg and bake until the pastry is crisp and golden.
8. Rest briefly before slicing and serving.

Prepared by Emanuel John Falzon's Team





Maltese beef olives

Cooking steps

1. Flatten thin slices of beef and season them lightly.
2. Mix breadcrumbs with chopped parsley, garlic, grated cheese, and hard-boiled egg for the filling.
3. Place a little filling on each slice, roll tightly, and secure with kitchen string or toothpicks.
4. Brown the rolls in olive oil, then remove them from the pan.
5. Cook chopped onion and carrot until soft, then add red wine, tomatoes, and a bay leaf.
6. Return the beef rolls to the sauce, cover, and simmer slowly until tender.
7. Remove the string or toothpicks and serve with the sauce and vegetables.

Prepared by Emanuel John Falzon's Team





Date-filled pastries

Cooking steps

1. Cook chopped dates gently with a little water, citrus zest, aniseed, and cinnamon until soft.
2. Mash the mixture into a thick paste and allow it to cool.
3. Prepare a firm pastry dough, then roll it into long, thin strips.
4. Place a line of date filling along each strip and fold the dough over to enclose it.
5. Flatten slightly and cut into diamond-shaped pieces.
6. Fry until golden and crisp, or bake for a lighter version.
7. Drain well and serve warm or at room temperature.

Prepared by Emanuel John Falzon's Team





RATATOUILLE

FRANCE

Provençal baked vegetables

Cooking steps

1. Wash and slice all the vegetables into thin rounds.
2. Chop the onion and cook it in olive oil until soft.
3. Spread the cooked onion in a baking dish.
4. Arrange the vegetable slices in alternating rows.
5. Drizzle olive oil over the vegetables.
6. Season with salt and pepper.
7. Bake at 180°C (350°F) for about 40 minutes.
8. Serve hot as a main dish or side dish.

Prepared by Lynda Bouali's Team





QUICHE LORRAINE

FRANCE

Lorraine bacon and egg tart

Cooking steps

1. Line a tart tin with shortcrust pastry and prick the base with a fork.
2. Cook diced bacon until lightly browned, then drain away excess fat.
3. Spread the bacon evenly over the pastry base.
4. Whisk eggs with cream, a little milk, salt, pepper, and nutmeg.
5. Pour the custard over the bacon without overfilling the case.
6. Bake until the filling is set and the top is lightly golden.
7. Rest for a few minutes before slicing and serve warm or at room temperature.

Prepared by Lynda Bouali's Team





FIADONE

FRANCE

Corsican brocciu and lemon cheesecake

Cooking steps

1. Preheat the oven to 150°C and lightly butter a 22 cm round tin.
2. Drain 500 g of brocciu and break it up until smooth.
3. Beat 4 eggs with 150 g of sugar and vanilla until blended.
4. Fold in the brocciu and the finely grated zest of 1 unwaxed lemon.
5. Pour the mixture into the tin and level the surface.
6. Bake for about 30 minutes, until set and lightly golden.
7. Cool completely before unmoulding, then chill before serving.

Prepared by Lynda Bouali's Team





OMELETTE AU BROCCIU

FRANCE

Corsican brocciu and mint omelette

Cooking steps

1. Crumble 250 g of fresh brocciu and finely slice 8–10 mint leaves.
2. Beat 8 eggs with salt and pepper, then fold in the brocciu and mint.
3. Warm 2 tablespoons of olive oil in a frying pan over medium heat.
4. Pour in the mixture and cook until the underside is lightly golden.
5. Lift the edges gently so the uncooked egg can flow underneath.
6. Fold the omelette in half while the centre is still tender.
7. Serve immediately, with a simple salad if desired.

Prepared by Lynda Bouali's Team





BOUILLABAISSE

FRANCE

Provençal fish stew

Cooking steps

1. Gently cook leek, onion, fennel, and garlic in olive oil.
2. Add tomatoes, orange peel, thyme, bay leaf, and a pinch of saffron.
3. Pour in fish stock and simmer to create a fragrant broth.
4. Add firm fish pieces first and cook them gently without stirring too strongly.
5. Add delicate fish and shellfish near the end, cooking only until just done.
6. Season with salt and pepper and remove any unopened shellfish.
7. Serve the broth and seafood hot with toasted bread and rouille.

Prepared by Lynda Bouali's Team





CRÊPES

FRANCE

Thin French pancakes

Cooking steps

1. Whisk flour, eggs, milk, a pinch of salt, and melted butter into a smooth batter.
2. Leave the batter to rest for about 30 minutes.
3. Heat a lightly buttered frying pan over medium heat.
4. Pour in a small ladleful of batter and tilt the pan to form a thin layer.
5. Cook until the edges lift, then turn and cook the second side briefly.
6. Repeat with the remaining batter, stacking the cooked crêpes.
7. Serve with sugar and lemon, fruit, jam, chocolate, or a savoury filling.

Prepared by Lynda Bouali's Team





COCOTTE CORSE DE VEAU AUX OLIVES

FRANCE

Corsican veal casserole with green olives

Cooking steps

1. Peel and finely chop 1 onion and 1 garlic clove.
2. Brown 1.2 kg of veal pieces in a little olive oil in a heavy casserole.
3. Add the onion and garlic and cook for about 5 minutes.
4. Stir in 1 tablespoon of flour, 10 cl of white wine, a bouquet garni and enough water to barely cover.
5. Season, cover and simmer gently for about 1 hour 15 minutes.
6. Add 100 g of green olives and 200 g of sliced mushrooms; cook for 15 minutes more.
7. Serve hot with salad or seasonal vegetables.

Prepared by Lynda Bouali's Team





TARTE TATIN

FRANCE

Upside-down caramelised apple tart

Cooking steps

1. Peel, core, and halve firm apples.
2. Melt butter and sugar in an ovenproof pan until a golden caramel forms.
3. Arrange the apples tightly in the caramel and cook gently until they begin to soften.
4. Cover the apples with a round of pastry and tuck the edges down inside the pan.
5. Bake until the pastry is crisp and golden.
6. Allow the tart to rest briefly, then carefully invert it onto a serving plate.
7. Serve warm, plain or with crème fraîche.

Prepared by Lynda Bouali's Team



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